Life After the Cliff

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Artist Talk

After 15 or so years of existing within the so-called Ivory Towers of academia I made the decision to leave the compound. For me the decision to do so was akin to jumping off a cliff, a cliff so high I couldn't see what was at the bottom. The last five years of my academic career was fraught with the fear of eventually being pushed off the cliff involuntarily so the decision to actually take the jump of my own free will was both liberating and to some degree empowering. I would like to outline my professional practice since leaving the university system and how many of the skills acquired within academia have assisted with my career as a freelance musician/programmer/etc. I would also like to discuss the competing imperatives of both academic and commercial environments. In many contexts the imperatives are the same however there are several which require radically different approaches.

I would like to do this with reference to the projects I have been involved in, to outline the varied array of activities and the challenges each project has presented.